Research Ethics Screening Form for Students

(For students on taught programmes only, NOT for PGRs - MRes/MPhil/PhD)

Middlesex University is concerned with protecting the rights, health, safety, dignity, and privacy of its research participants. It is also concerned with protecting the health, safety, rights, and academic freedom of its students and with safeguarding its own reputation for conducting high quality, ethical research.

*This Research Ethics Screening Form will enable taught students to self-assess and determine whether their research requires ethical review and approval via the online **Ethics Monitor** before commencing their study. Supervisors must approve this form after consultation with students.*

Student Name:		Email:
Research project title:		
Programme of study/module:		
Supervisor Name:		Email:

Please answer whether your research/study involves any of the following given below:		
1. [H]ANIMALS or animal parts.	☐ Yes	☐ No
2. [M]CELL LINES (established and commercially available cells - biological research).	☐ Yes	☐ No
3. [H]CELL CULTURE (Primary: from animal/human cells- biological research).	☐ Yes	☐ No
4. [H]CLINICAL Audits or Assessments (e.g. in medical settings).	☐ Yes	☐ No
5. [X]CONFLICT of INTEREST or lack of IMPARTIALITY. If unsure see "Code of Practice for Research" (Sec 3.5) at: https://unihub.mdx.ac.uk/study/spotlights/types/research-at-middlesex/research-ethics	☐ Yes	☐ No
6. [X]DATA to be used that is not freely available (e.g. secondary data needing permission for access or use).	☐ Yes	☐ No
7. [X]DAMAGE (e.g., to precious artefacts or to the environment) or present a significant risk to society).	☐ Yes	☐ No
8. [X]EXTERNAL ORGANISATION – research carried out within an external organisation or your research is commissioned by a government (or government body).	☐ Yes	☐ No
9. [M]FIELDWORK (e.g., biological research, ethnography studies).	☐ Yes	☐ No
10.[H]GENETICALLTY MODIFIED ORGANISMS (GMOs) (biological research).	☐ Yes	☐ No
11. [H]GENE THERAPY including DNA sequenced data (biological research).	☐ Yes	☐ No
12. [M]HUMAN PARTICIPANTS – ANONYMOUS Questionnaires (participants not identified or identifiable).	☐ Yes	☐ No
13. [X]HUMAN PARTICIPANTS – IDENTIFIABLE (participants are identified or can be identified): survey questionnaire/ INTERVIEWS / focus groups / experiments / observation studies/ evaluation studies.	☐ Yes	☐ No

14. [H]HUMAN TISSUE (e.g., human relevant material, e.g., blood, saliva, urine, breast milk, faecal material).	☐ Yes	☐ No
15.[H]ILLEGAL/HARMFUL activities research (e.g., development of technology intended to be used in an illegal/harmful context or to breach security systems, searching the internet for information on highly sensitive topics such as child and extreme pornography, terrorism, use of the DARK WEB, research harmful to national security).	☐ Yes	☐ No
16. [X]PERMISSION is required to access premises or research participants.	☐ Yes	☐ No
17. [X]PERSONAL DATA PROCESSING (Any activity with data that can directly or indirectly identify a living person). For example, data gathered from interviews, databases, digital devices such as mobile phones, social media or internet platforms or apps with or without individuals'/owners' knowledge or consent, and/or could lead to individuals/owners being IDENTIFIED or SPECIAL CATEGORY DATA (GDPR[1]) or CRIMINAL OFFENCE DATA. [1]Special category data (GDPR- Art.9): "personal data revealing racial or ethnic origin, political opinions, religious or philosophical beliefs, or trade union membership, and the processing of genetic data, biometric data for the purpose of uniquely identifying a natural person, data concerning health or data concerning a natural person's sex life or sexual orientation".	☐ Yes	☐ No
18.[X]PUBLIC WORKS DOCTORATES: Evidence of permission is required for use of works/artifacts (that are protected by Intellectual Property (IP) Rights, e.g. copyright, design right) in a doctoral critical commentary when the IP in the work/artifacts jointly prepared/produced or is owned by another body	☐ Yes	☐ No
19. [H]RISK OF PHYSICAL OR PSYCHOLOGICAL HARM (e.g., TRAVEL to dangerous places in your own country or in a foreign country (see https://www.gov.uk/foreign-travel-advice), research with NGOs/humanitarian groups in conflict/dangerous zones, development of technology/agent/chemical that may be harmful to others, any other foreseeable dangerous risks).	☐ Yes	☐ No
20.[H]SECURITY CLEARANCE – required for research.	☐ Yes	☐ No
21.[H]SENSITIVE TOPICS (e.g., anything deeply personal and distressing, taboo, intrusive, stigmatising, sexual in nature, potentially dangerous, etc).	☐ Yes	☐ No

M – Minimal Risk; X – More than Minimal Risk. H – High Risk

If you have answered 'Yes' to ANY of the items in the table, your application REQUIRES ethical review and approval using the online **Ethics Monitor BEFORE commencing your research**. Please apply for ethical review and approval using the **Ethics Monitor**. Further information such as links to access **Ethics Monitor** & training videos is available at MyLearning(*Middlesex Online Research Ethics) area*: https://mdx.mrooms.net/course/view.php?id=12277 (Login required).

If you have answered 'No' to ALL of the items in the table, your application is Low Risk and you may NOT require ethical review and approval using **Ethics Monitor** before commencing your research. Your research supervisor will confirm this below.

Evaluation Plan / Analysis Plan

Before proceeding with the signature, provide a small but concise write-up of about 400 to 700 words outlining Evaluation Plan / Analysis Plan for your project. This plan should entail the strategies, methodologies, and approaches you will employ to assess and analyse the outcome of the project upon its Development or Research Analysis phase is finalised. Do add references to back up the arguments. This will help the supervisor assess your Ethics screening form.

Overview of Evaluation Plan / Analysis Plan *References:*

Student Signature:…….…….…. Date:…….……

To be completed by the supervisor:

Based on the details provided in the self-assessment form, I confirm that:	Insert Y or N
The study is Low Risk and *does not require* ethical review & approval using **Ethics Monitor**	
The study *requires* ethical review and approval using **Ethics Monitor**	

Supervisor Signature:……..…….... Date:……..……